

CHAPTER 32: ANNUAL REPORTS

32.1 INTRODUCTION

- 1 The annual report is an important function of a traffic signal division. The purpose of the annual report is to provide information on the work of the division and to indicate that the work was undertaken responsibly and in the best interest of the community and the road user.
- 2 Performance management and the assessment of key performance indices are mechanisms to ensure that the goals and objectives of providing traffic signals are achieved. The annual report should provide information on the degree to which these goals and objectives have been reached.

32.2 CONTENTS OF THE ANNUAL REPORT

32.2.1 General

- 1 The annual report should provide information on aspects such as the following:
 - (a) Institutional.
 - (b) Special projects.
 - (c) Routine projects.
 - (d) Training and technology transfer.
 - (e) Programme and budget.
 - (f) Statistics.
- 2 Throughout the report there should be an emphasis on achievements and the degree to which key performance indices have been achieved.

32.2.2 Institutional

- 1 The annual report should contain information on the institutional and organisational structure as well as staff composition of the traffic signal division. Staff shortages and vacancies should also be indicated.
- 2 The facilities available in the traffic division should also be described, together with an indication of the traffic control system in use.
- 3 Information should also be given on the utilisation of consulting engineers and contractors, as well as the projects on which they were utilised.
- 4 Details should also be provided on co-operation with other authorities as well as duties undertaken on behalf of such authorities.

32.2.3 Special projects

- 1 The annual report should provide short summaries of special projects that have been undertaken by the traffic signal division.
- 2 Special projects would, for example, include upgrading to a new traffic signal system, installation of an operations control centre, installation of new traffic signals, etc. A special project is one that is not routinely undertaken each year.

32.2.4 Routine projects

- 1 Routine projects are those routinely undertaken each year. These include the upgrading of traffic signal settings, maintenance activities, etc.
- 2 A short description should be given in the report of all the routine activities of the signal division.

32.2.5 Training and technology transfer

- 1 The development of skills and knowledge in the traffic signal division is of such importance that it warrants a special section in the annual report. The signal division should be proud of any efforts made to provide training and to provide opportunities to personnel to improve their knowledge of traffic signalisation.
- 2 The report should highlight the importance of continued skill development and may refer to this manual to indicate the responsibility of road authorities to institute specific programmes at improving skills and knowledge.

32.2.6 Programme and budget

- 1 One of the essential elements of the report is the work programme and budget of the traffic signal division, for the current year as well as the future year.
- 2 Proper account must be given of all work and expenses undertaken by the traffic signal division. Any new proposed projects should be well motivated and their benefits to the community and the road user explained.

32.2.7 Statistics

- 1 Detailed statistics should be given in the report on all the activities of the traffic signal division. These statistics must cover the work of all personnel as well as consulting engineers and contractors.
- 2 Statistics should be given on aspects such as the following:
 - (a) Staff levels, subdivided according to function and qualifications.
 - (b) Traffic signal installations and other facilities.
 - (c) New traffic signal installations.
 - (d) Upgraded traffic signal installations.
 - (e) Traffic studies and accident statistics.
 - (f) Maintenance activities.
 - (g) Reported malfunctions, subdivided into classes of malfunctions.

